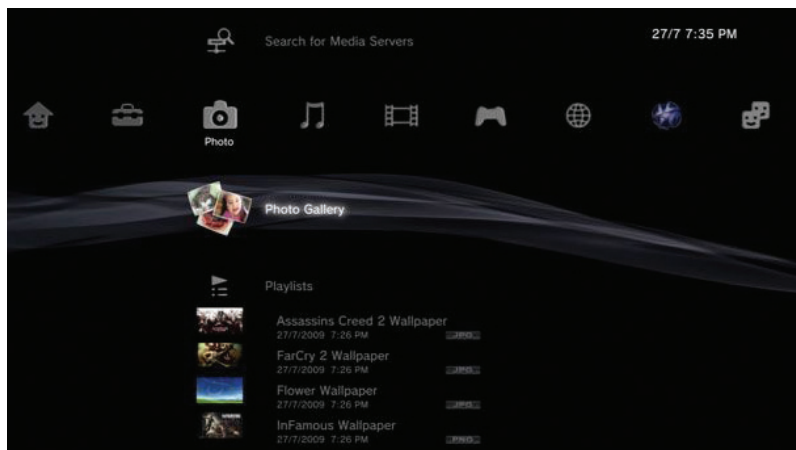




The XMB is fully controlled by the SixAxis or the DualShock 3, and uses 10 main categories to start off with: Users, Settings, Photo, Music, Video, Game, Network, PlayStation Network, PlayStation Home and Friends.

Sony also hit upon an innovative way to make the XMB wallpaper vibrant: the background of the XMB changes its colour on the 15th and 24th of each month, while the brightness of the colour changes its shade throughout the day. Of course, users can always select a background colour and shade and make it permanent, or use an image stored on their hard disk as the permanent wallpaper.

The XMB is fully controlled by the SixAxis or the DualShock 3, and uses ten main categories to start off with: Users, Settings, Photo, Music, Video, Game, Network, PlayStation Network, PlayStation Home and Friends. If you have the PlayTV tuner add-on installed, another option called 'TV' shows up as well.

This menu can be operated using the left and right keys on the navigational pad of the controller, with a pause upon any of the ten categories opening up a drop-down list of tasks you can perform in that category. To select an item, press X, while to return to the previous item, press O.

For example, with games, you could either play the game on the disk that is currently loaded in your Blu-ray ROM, or you could play a demo of some other game; and if you have downloaded any title from the PlayStation Network, that can also be accessed from here.

The PS3 includes the ability to store various master and secondary user profiles, manage and explore photos with Photo Gallery or an ordinary musical/non-musical slideshow, rip audio CDs, rip iTunes AAC protected files, play music and copy tracks to an attached storage device, play movies and video files from the hard disk drive, an optional USB mass storage or Flash card, or an optical disk. The 'Friends' menu allows email with emoticons and attached picture features and video chat which requires an optional Webcam. The PlayStation Network menu